Voyager 1 Will Soon Be One Light-Day From Earth

From: DOGOnews Mined: 2026-10-13 3 min read

NASA launched Voyager 1 in 1977. It was supposed to last just five years. Almost 50 years later, it is still working!

Voyager 1 zooms through space at about 38,000 miles per hour. If it stays on course, it will be one **light-day** from Earth on November 18, 2026. A **light-day** is how far light travels in one day, about 16 billion miles. No human-made object has ever been that far away.

Voyager 1 first studied Jupiter and Saturn. It sent back pictures of their rings and moons. Then it kept going. In 2012, it entered **interstellar space**, the area far beyond the Sun.

Its power source is slowly making less **electricity**. To save energy, NASA **engineers** have turned off some of its tools. On April 17, 2026, they shut off one that measured **charged particles**. Two tools still work.

NASA hopes Voyager 1 can keep sending information for many more years.

Word Treasure

light-day -- How far light travels in one day, about 16 billion miles.
interstellar space -- The space between stars, far beyond the Sun.
engineers -- People who design, build and fix machines.
charged particles -- Tiny bits of matter that carry electricity.
electricity -- A kind of energy that powers machines and lights.

Background you need

Voyager 1 is a spacecraft with no people on board, controlled by NASA engineers on Earth.

Light is the fastest thing there is, so scientists use it to measure huge distances in space.

Spacecraft that go very far from the Sun need special power sources because sunlight is too weak there.

Break it down

WHO: NASA's Voyager 1 spacecraft and the engineers who run it
WHAT: Voyager 1 will soon be one light-day from Earth, farther than any human-made object
WHERE: Interstellar space, far beyond the Sun
WHY: It has kept working for almost 50 years, much longer than planned

Why it matters

Voyager 1 shows that well-built machines can explore far into space and teach us about places no one can visit.

Test what you remember

1. When did NASA launch Voyager 1?

- (A) 1950
- (B) 2012
- (C) 2026
- (D) 1977

2. How long was Voyager 1 supposed to last?

- (A) Five years
- (B) Fifty years
- (C) One month
- (D) Forever

3. How fast does Voyager 1 travel?

- (A) About 38,000 miles per hour
- (B) About 100 miles per hour
- (C) About 60 miles per hour
- (D) It is not moving

4. When will Voyager 1 be one light-day from Earth?

- (A) December 25, 2030
- (B) Next week
- (C) April 17, 2026
- (D) November 18, 2026

5. Which planets did Voyager 1 study first?

- (A) Earth and the Moon
- (B) Jupiter and Saturn
- (C) Pluto and Neptune
- (D) Mars and Venus

6. Why did engineers turn off some of its tools?

- (A) Because it landed
- (B) To save energy
- (C) Because they were too loud
- (D) To make it go faster

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: A 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):